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Cancer services

Find out about our comprehensive treatment options and support services available to cancer patients across our hospitals.

Where to find this service

Where to find this service	Sunshine Hospital	Williamstown Hospital

What we do

Western Health's cancer service is the largest care provider for people with cancer across the wider Western region.

Sunshine Hospital is the primary cancer services hub, providing up to 20 inpatient beds on a shared ward. Patients with cancer are also admitted at Footscray, Williamstown and Bacchus Marsh Hospital for surgical procedures.

Melton Health and Community Services also provide support through your cancer diagnosis. This includes chemotherapy if indicated. Please note that there is no radiotherapy treatment available at Melton Health. This can be arranged to be done at Peter Mac at Sunshine by their Oncologist.

Chemotherapy

Chemotherapy is provided at Sunshine Chemotherapy Day Unit (CDU), Melton Health Day Medical Unit and Sunbury Day Hospital. Radiation Therapy are also provided at the Sunshine Hospital Radiation Therapy Centre, which is a service partnership with Peter McCallum Cancer Centre.

Oncology Hospital in the Home (HITH) provides oncology care at home where possible.

Emergency care

Emergency care is provided to cancer patients presenting at Sunshine, Footscray, Williamstown Emergency Departments (ED) and Bacchus Marsh and Melton Health Urgent Care. Sunshine Hospital also operates a Symptom Urgent Review Clinic (SURC), via the CDU, providing an alternative avenue to the ED to access acute specialised care for patients on chemotherapy.

Palliative care

Our Palliative Care Service provides a comprehensive range of services to patients living with a life-threatening illness, including a designated inpatient palliative care unit, a hospital-based consultancy service and outpatient clinics. There are 20 inpatient beds located at Sunshine Hospital, where the focus of care is on symptom management and support to patients and their families.

The Consultancy Service provides palliative care expertise to patients, carers and health professionals across all campuses and also liaises closely with community agencies.

The collaboration with community services has been strengthened with the development of the outpatient SMART (Symptom Management and Referral Team) clinics in conjunction with Mercy Palliative Care.

Our palliative care service extends regionally to Bacchus Marsh Regional Hospital that has dedicated palliative care beds and a community palliative care service.

Outpatient care, support services and treatment planning

Cancer outpatient services are available at Sunshine, Footscray, Sunbury and Melton Health. Several key support services are involved in delivering care for cancer patients at Western Health including:

- medical imaging
- interventional radiology
- pathology
- pharmacy.

Treatment planning plays an integral role in supporting positive outcomes from cancer care. Western Health cancer services operate high-quality tumour-specific multidisciplinary meetings, optimising treatment and management planning.

We gather input from multiple clinicians across relevant clinical specialties, including:

- medical, radiation and surgical oncology
- radiology
- pathology
- allied health
- nursing.

Services and facilities

Our cancer services and clinics include:

- acute inpatient services including medical oncology, haematology, chemotherapy and surgery
- subacute inpatient palliative care
- research and clinical trials
- Symptom and Urgent Review Clinic (SURC)
- non-admitted services, including specialist clinics and radiotherapy
- community palliative care
- Oncology Hospital in the Home (HITH) (provision of chemotherapy in the patient's home)
- allied health support.

Cancer services partnerships:

Peter Mac - We partner with Peter MacCallum Cancer Centre (Peter Mac) to provide radiation oncology service at SHRTC.

Mercy Palliative Care (MPC) - We partner with a range of community palliative care providers, including MPC, to provide essential end-of-life support and symptom management to a large portion of Western Health patients receiving cancer care.

Through patient-centred models, MPC provides community palliative care services in patients' own homes, while WH operate inpatient palliative care at Sunshine and the multidisciplinary Symptom Management and Referral Team (SMART) clinics at Footscray and Sunshine campuses.

VCCC Alliance - Western Health is a member of the Victorian Comprehensive Cancer Centre Alliance (VCCC). The VCCC uses an integrated and innovative approach to cancer research, clinical trials, education and patient care in Victoria, with the aim to translate research into practice and advance quality clinical care.

Western Health is also part of the West Metropolitan Health Service Partnership (Mercy Health, Royal Women's Hospital, Royal Children's Hospital, Peter Mac and Melbourne Health) and the Western Central Melbourne Integrated Cancer Services (WCMICS) as well as North and West Metropolitan Palliative Care Consortium and Grampians Region Palliative Care Consortium.

Cancers treated at Western Health:

Breast Cancer Service – include Breast Cancer CNCs

Colorectal Cancer Service

Genito-Urinary Cancer Service – include Prostate CNCs

General Oncology Service

Gynae-Oncology Cancer Service

Haematology Cancer Service

Lung Cancer Service – include Lung Cancer CNCs

Skin Cancer

SMART Clinic

Thyroid Tumours

Upper Gastro-Intestinal Cancer Service

Other Cancer Types

Contact

Cancer Research and Clinical Trials

Place/Role: Sunshine Hospital, Ward 1E – Chemotherapy Day Unit

Email: CancerClinicalTrials@wh.org.au
Phone: (03) 8395 9167

Cancer Nurse Consultants

Place/Role: McGrath Breast Cancer Nurse Consultants

Email: MBCNReferrals@wh.org.au
Phone: 0468 577 996 / 0479 192 093

Place/Role: McGrath Lung Cancer Nurse Consultant

Email: LCCN@wh.org.au
Phone: 0479181113

Place/Role: Prostate Care Nurse

Email: ProstateCancerNurse@wh.org.au
Phone: 0411 853 290

Chemotherapy

Place/Role: Symptoms Urgent Review Clinic, **Sunshine Hospital, Ward 1E –** Chemotherapy Day Unit
Phone: (03) 8395 9159 / 0421 570 707

Place/Role: Sunshine Hospital, Ward 1E – Chemotherapy Day Unit
Phone: (03) 8395 9177

Place/Role: Oncology Hospital in the Home (HITH), **Sunshine Hospital, Ward 1E –** Chemotherapy Day Unit
Phone: (03) 8395 9177

Inpatient Wards

Place/Role: Sunshine Hospital, Ward 2E
Phone: (03) 8395 9329

Place/Role: Sunshine Hospital, Ward GD - Palliative Care
Phone: (03) 8345 1792

Melton Health and Community Services

Place/Role: Referral and Appointment Service
Phone: 9747 7609

Days and times: Oncology sessions run on Tuesdays each week.

Palliative Care

Place/Role: Palliative Care Consultancy Nurse Consultants
Phone: Sunshine: (03) 8395 9164 or (03) 8395 9163

Phone: Footscray: (03) 8345 7068

Place/Role: Bacchus Marsh Community Palliative Care Nurse Consultants

Radiotherapy

Place/Role: Sunshine Hospital Radiation Therapy Centre

Days and times: Monday to Friday 8am–6pm

Phone: (03) 8395 9999

Visit the Sunshine Hospital Radiation Therapy Centre for more information.

Registrars for the following:

- Breast Surgical
- Colorectal Surgical
- Gynaecological
- Haematology
- Oncology
- Palliative Care
- Thoracics or Respiratory (Lung)
- Upper Gastrointestinal Surgical

- Urology (Genito-Urinary)

Phone: Contact via switch on (03) 8345 6666

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